

1 2 3 is not the only way.

Odia keeps its own set of ten digits, and they are still printed on buses, exam papers and calendars in Odisha today.

୦ 0 shuunya	୧ 1 eka	୨ 2 dui	୩ 3 tini	୪ 4 chaari
୫ 5 paancha	୬ 6 chhaa	୭ 7 saata	୮ 8 aatha	୯ 9 naa

Write the year you were born.

One Odia digit per box. Check it against the table above — no peeking at a phone.



That circle is a big deal. Treating zero as a number you can actually calculate with — add it, subtract it, and state the rules — was worked out in India. Brahmagupta set those rules down in **628 CE**, centuries before the idea reached Europe. Every empty box you have ever left blank on a maths paper owes it something.